

Parliamentary System In India: A Sociological Perspective

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Abstract

The Connection Between The Ruled And The Rulers Determines Politics. One, A Small Group Of Individuals, Or A Large Electorate Can Uphold A Rule. Sociologists Have Been Particularly Interested In The State, But They Have Examined It In Relation To Society Rather Than In Isolation. Sociologists Investigate The Structure Of Society As A Whole Because They Believe That Human Behavior Creates Society. The Most Well-Known Political Institutions Are The Executive Branch, Which Sets Policy, The Legislature, Which Examines Policies And Restrains The President's Authority, And The Judiciary, Which Makes Sure The Constitution Is Upheld. The Constitution Is Only An Enabling Instrument That Sets Limits On The Use Of Authority. They Might Relate To The Division Of Authority Among The Government's Legislative, Executive, And Judicial Branches. They Could Also Be The Outcome Of Legislative Oversight Of The Executive. Pluralism Is Used To Explain How Power Is Distributed And Organized In Democratic Western Societies. Party Involvement Is Emphasized As The Conduit Between The Government And Society. The Distribution Of Power Among Various Public And Private Entities Receives More Attention Than The Operations Of Governmental Agencies, Legislatures, And Committees—The Typical Tools Of Governance. Elite Theory Differs From Both Pluralism And Functionalism In That It Sees A Small Minority As Holding All The Power In Society. Modern Democracies, In Pareto's View, Are Only Another Manifestation Of Elite Domination. He Scornfully Rejected Those Who Saw Them As A More Progressive And Representative Form Of Government. Nonetheless, Particularly In His Later Writings, Mosca Insisted That There Were Important Differences Between Democracies And Other Forms Of Elite Domination. Although Popular Emotion And Opinions Are The True Constitutional Centers In A Parliamentary System, Parliament, Not The People, Is The Ultimate Source Of

Sovereignty. Any Legislation Can Be Made By Parliament.

Key Words: Sociological Perspective, Parliamentary System, Elite And Pluralism Theories

Introduction

Politic Is A Function Of The Relationship Between Rulers And Ruled. Rule May Be Carried On By One, A Few Or Many People (Electorate). The State And The Many Branches Of Government, Including The Legislature And The Courts, Have Been The Focus Of Political Studies. The State Has Been Of Special Interest To Sociologists, But They Have Studied It In The Context Of Society As A Whole Rather Than Separately. Sociologists View Society As The Result Of Human Activity And Base Their Analysis On An Investigation Of The Structure Of Society As A Whole. They Also Believe That Society Greatly Influences Human Conduct. Sociology Is A Scientific Discipline That Focuses On The Interpretation Of Social Behavior And, Consequently, The Causal Explanation Of Its Occurrence And Outcomes. The Parliamentary System Maintains Close Connection Between The Executive And The Legislature As The Cabinet Which Is The Real Executive The Cabinets Consist Of Leaders Of The Party That Is In The Majority Or Have Support In The Legislature.

Democracy

Blessing Of Society Depends Entirely On The Constitution Of Government. The Form Of Government Which Communicates Ease, Comfort, And Security Is The Best. Recently Governments Are Becoming More And More Democratic In Which The Rule Of Law, Representation And Secure Freedom For All Has Prevailed. With Such Democracy All Can Realize Their Own Potentialities. Democracy, According To Max Weber, Is A Political System In Which The People Choose A Leader They Can Trust. Once This Is Done, The Elected Leader Has The Authority To Enforce The Strictest Silence On Individuals And Groups, And He Or She Will Not Be Criticized Or Condemned Unless He Or She Has Made Serious Mistakes. (Michels,1949).

Constitution

The Best Known Political Institution Are The Branches Of Government The

Executive- Responsible For Policy Making , The Legislature Reviews Policy And Checks The Power Of Executive , The Judiciary Insures That Constitution Is Not Violated . Institutions Require A Frame Work Of Principle From Which They Take Credence. The Frame Work Is Constitution Which Distributes Power According It Ideology. Constitution Is Only An Enabling Document That Establishes Boundaries Around The Exercise Of Power. Constitution Represents A Fiction Of Social Contract Establishing The Condition Under Which The Sovereignty Of People Extended To Their Representative By Means Of Elections The Constitution Supposes That It Constitute The Governments To Make Law And Carry Out Wishes Of Majority. The Second Principle Is Notion Of Check And Balances. They May Be In Terms Of Separation Of Power Between The Legislative, Executive, And Judicial Branches Of Government Or They May Be The Result Of Parliamentary Control Over The Executive.

Parliamentary System

The Parliamentary System Maintains Close Connection Between The Executive And The Legislature As The Cabinet Which Is The Real Executive The Cabinets Consists Of Leaders Of The Party That Is In The Majority Or Have Support In The Legislature. Under Parliamentary System, If A Prime Minister Has A Powerful Majority In Parliament And Is Able To Maintain Discipline Over The Party, The Cabinet Can Garner Great Power Simply By Its Ability To Win Every Parliamentary Vote. However, There Is Always The Danger Of Cabinet Dictatorship. Most Parliamentary System Has An Executive Who Serves Solely As The Symbol Of Government. Whether President , Prime Minister , Or Monarch , The Executive Undertakes The Business Of State , Opening Legislative Sessions , Making Speeches, Accepting Ambassadors , Validating Appointments , Signing Legislation , And Generally Representing Authority In The Abstract . The Real Power Of Executive Law Is Exercised By A Prime Minister And The Cabinet, Who Make Up An “Executive Committee”.

Political Parties

The Parliamentary System Is Predicated On The Idea That The People As A Whole Ultimately Have The Power And That The State And Government Operate In

The Best Interests Of The Citizens And In Accordance With Their Desires. Democracy Is A Vast Concept. Thus, It Cannot Operate In The Absence Of Masses. Electoral Masses Are Implied By Electionism, Which Is A Prerequisite For Parliamentarism. It Follows That Political Parties Are In Part Aristocratic In Their Origin And Goal, Even Though It Is Still True That They Must Exploit The People. A Fundamental Aspect Of Representative Governance Is The Competition Between Two Or More Political Parties. A Political Party Is An Organization That Works To Elect Representatives To Local Or National Legislatures. In Parliamentary System Party Organization Hold Permanent Offices And The Must Always Be Ready For General Elections Due To The Possible Consequences Of A Vote Of Confidence.

They Are Mass Coalitional Organization Appealing To Voters; They Are Responsive To Special Interest. While In Theory Representing Individuals In Practice Parties Represent Organization Business Interest Coalitions.

Max Weber Asserts That The Political Party Has Two Distinct Teleology's. It Is A Spontaneous Organization Of Agitation And Propaganda That Aspires To Gain Power In Order To Provide Its Active Militant Followers With Opportunities, Both Material And Ideal, For The Accomplishment Of Either Personal Advantages Or Objective Goals, Or Both. (Michel's, 1949). Interest Groups, In Contrast To Political Parties, Do Not Seek To Establish A Government. Instead, They Aim To Sway Political Parties And The Different Authorities, Which Is The Recognized Form Of Power. Department Of State Without Actually Taking On The Responsibilities Of Power. Some Interest Groups Like Trade Unions, Represent Particular Segment Of The Population That Have Protective Functions Quite Apart From Their Influence In Politics.

Power

The Most Important Feature Of A Constitution Is How It Distributes Power. Political Sociology, According To Sociologists, Is The Study Of Power, Which Includes The Capacity To Achieve Your Goals Despite Opposition From Others. Sociologists Often Distinguish Between Two Forms Of Power, Authority And Coercion: The Type Of Power That Is Not Considered To Be Lawful Is Coercion.

Theory Of Pluralism

One Hypothesis That Seeks To Explain The Structure And Allocation Of Power In Democratic Western Cultures Is Pluralism. It Emphasizes Party Participation As The Link Between Society And Government. Less Attention Is Given To How Governmental Agencies , Legislatures , Committees – The Usual Instruments Of Government –Work Than To How Power Is Shared Among A Variety Of Groups, Both Public And Private. The Status Of Pluralism In Relation To Theories Of Power Concentration Is The Most Contentious Topic In Political Science.

Elite Theory

Elite Theory Views Power In Society As Being Monopolized By A Tiny Minority, Which Sets It Apart From Both Pluralism And Functionalism. According To Elite Theory, Society Is Split Into Two Major Groups: The Governed And The Ruling Minority, Who Use The State To Wield Their Authority.

The Link Between Power And Governing Dates Back To The Franco-Italian School Of Political Sociology, And One Of The Major Difficulties Surrounding C. Wright Mills' (1984, 1956) Work Likewise Centers On The Issue, "Who Governs?" For Members Of The Machiavellian School, Such As Roberto, Michel, And Vilfredo Pareto, The Idea Of The Ruling Class Was Not The Same As The Idea Of The Governing Class. They Were More Interested In Who Ruled Than In Who Governs. Their Argument States That The Ruling Class Designates A Body To Oversee The Official Judicial System Of Government, Raising The Question Of "Who Governs." Doesn't Even Acknowledge The Topic Of "Who Rules"?

However, There Are Other Ways In Which Elite Theorists Diverge. They Disagree On Whether Elite Dominance Is Good For Society Or Desired, And They Have Different Opinions On How Inevitable Elite Rule Is.; And They Do Not Agree About Exactly Who Constitutes The Elite Or Elites Elite Theory Was First Developed By Two Italian Sociologists: Vilfredo Pareto (1848-1923) And Gaetano Mosca (1858-1911). Both Rejected The Notion That A Proletarian Revolution Could Lead To The Establishment Of A Communist Society And Believed That Elite Control Was Unavoidable. They Were Thereby Contesting Marx's Conception Of The State And Power.

Because Elite Dominance Is Unavoidable, Neither Party Thought It Was

Worthwhile To Try To Stop It. Pareto And Mosca Concurred That The Superior Personal Attributes Of The Elites Were The Foundation Of Elite Power. Mosca Perceived Elites As Having More Organizational Skills, Whereas Pareto Thought They Were More Clever Or Cunning. Some Would Always Be More Capable Than Others Due To The Unequal Distribution Of Individuals, And As A Result, They Would Hold The Most Prestigious Positions In Society.

Both Theorists Contend That An Elite's Internal Structure, Rather Than The Individual Characteristics Of Its Members, Is What Gives It Power; It Creates A Coherent And Unified Minority Against A Disorganized And Dispersed Bulk. In Mosca's Words, 'The Power Of The Minority Is Irresistible As Against Each Single Individual In The Majority: Major Decisions That Affect Society Are Taken By The Elite. Even In So-Called Democratic Societies, These Decisions Will Usually Reflect The Concerns Of The Elite Rather Than The Wishes Of The People'. According To Elite Theorists, Most People Are Indifferent To The Main Concerns Of The Day. By Passively Believing The Propaganda That Defends Elite Power, The Majority Of The Populace Is Mainly Under The Influence And Manipulation Of The Elite. Although There Are Broad Similarities Between The Works Of These Classical Elite Theorists, There Are Also Some Differences. (Haralambos & Holborn,2013)

Vilfredo Pareto And Gaetano Mosca

Pareto Maintained That There Are Two Primary Categories Of Ruling Elites, Which He Dubbed Lions And Foxes After His Countryman And Intellectual Forebear, Niccol Machiavelli:

1. As Their Name Implies, Lions Like To Govern By Force, And Their Ability To Act Directly And Incisively Is What Gives Them Authority This Kind Of Ruling Class Is Exemplified By Military Dictatorships.
2. In Contrast, Foxes Govern Via Wheeling And Dealing, Diplomatic Manipulation, And Cunning And Deceit. Pareto Thought That This Kind Of Elite Was Exemplified By European Democracies. The Personal Characteristics Of The Ruling Elite, Such As Their Lion Or Fox Inclinations, Are Primarily Responsible For Their Positions. Mosca Shared Pareto's Belief That The Governing Minority Was Preferable To The Majority. He Claimed That They Were 'Distinguished From The Mm Of The Governed By Qualities That Give

Them A Certain Material, Intellectual Or Even Moral Superiority'. He Also Offered A Sociological Explanation For This Advantage, Arguing That It Results From The Elite's Social Background.

Elite Theory And Democracy

According To Pareto, Contemporary Democracies Are Just Another Example Of Elite Dominance. Those Who Viewed Them As A More Progressive And Representative Form Of Administration Were Scornfully Discarded By Him. However, Mosca Maintained That There Were Significant Distinctions Between Democracies And Other Types Of Elite Control, Especially In His Later Works. (Haralambos & Holborn,2013)

Who Makes The Law? Who Benefits?

Marxists Hold That Laws Are Made By The State, Which Represents The Interests Of The Ruling Class. Numerous Sociologists Have Observed How Many People In Capitalist Societies Interact With Property. For Instance, Hermann Mannheim's "The History Of Criminal Legislation In England" And Several Other Countries Demonstrate How The Law Placed An Undue Emphasis On Property Protection. (Mannheim, 1960). But When Trade And Commerce—Which Deal With Moveable Property—Grew In Significance And Capitalism Eventually Replaced Feudalism, A Plethora Of Laws Were Created To Safeguard The Property Rights Of The New Capitalist Class. According To Laureen Snider The Capitalist State Is Frequently Hesitant To Enact Regulations That Govern Major Capitalist Companies That Might Jeopardize Their Profits. (Snider,1993). She Draws Attention To The Fact That Capitalist Nations Frequently Employ Enormous Quantities Of Money To Entice Corporate Investment. They Provide Tax Breaks To New Investors, Low-Cost Loans And Subsidies, And Costly Infrastructure To Support Businesses. The State Is Hesitant To Take The Chance Of Upsetting Big Businesses After Making Such A Concerted Effort To Draw In Foreign Investment. The State Is Reluctant To Implement Or Enforce Stringent Regulations Against Pollution, Monopolies, And Worker Health And Safety, Snider Claims. Such Actions Scare Away Much Desired Investment And Cause The Equally Dreaded Loss Of Confidence. (Holmboes And Holboon,2013)

Non-Decision Making

Laws That Are Not Passed Are Just As Significant As Those That Are. Making No Decisions Is Just As Crucial As Making Them. Claimed That The Governing Class Had The Authority To Ensure That Only "Safe Decisions" Were Made And To Keep A Number Of Problems From Ever Coming To A Conclusion. (Haralambos, & Holborn,2013)

Conclusion

Politics Is Determined By The Relationship Between The Ruled And The Rulers. A Rule Can Be Upheld By A Vast Electorate, A Small Number Of People, Or Both. The State Has Piqued The Interest Of Sociologists, But They Have Studied It In Connection With Society Rather Than Alone. Because Sociologists Think That Human Conduct Shapes Society, They Study How Society Is Organized Overall. The Most Well-Known Political Institutions Are The Judiciary, Which Ensures That The Constitution Is Followed, The Legislature, Which Reviews Policies And Checks The President's Power, And The Executive Branch, Which Establishes Policies. The Constitution Just Serves As An Enabling Document That Places Restrictions On The Exercise Of Power.

The Separation Of Powers Between The Legislative, Executive, And Judicial Departments Of Government May Be One Of Them. Additionally, They Could Result From Parliamentary Monitoring Of The Executive Branch. In Democratic Western Cultures, The Distribution And Organization Of Power Are Explained By Pluralism. Participation In Political Parties Is Highlighted As The Link Between The State And The Populace. More Focus Is Placed On The Allocation Of Power Among Different Public And Private Organizations Than On The Activities Of Committees, Legislatures, And Governmental Agencies—The Usual Instruments Of Governance. In Contrast To Functionalism And Pluralism, Elite Theory Holds That A Small Minority Controls All Of Society's Authority. Pareto Saw Modern Democracies As Just Another Example Of Elite Dominance. Those Who Viewed Them As A More Progressive And Representative Form Of Administration Were Scornfully Rejected By Him. However, Mosca Maintained That There Were Significant Distinctions Between Democracies And Other Types Of Elite Dominance, Especially In His Later Works. Parliament,

Not The People, Is The Ultimate Source Of Sovereignty, Even If Public Sentiment And Views Are The Real Constitutional Centers In A Parliamentary System. Parliament Has The Authority To Enact Any Legislation. In The Parliamentary System Although The Real Constitutional Centers Are The Force Of Public Sentiment And Its Beliefs, Sovereignty Lies Not In The People But In Parliament. Parliament Can Make Any Law It Wants.

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